

NovaTech Solutions

Customer Support Knowledge Base

Official Reference Manual — Version 3.2

This document is the authoritative knowledge base for NovaTech Solutions customer support agents and the AI-powered support assistant. It covers all product lines, subscription plans, billing policies, technical troubleshooting, return and refund procedures, and escalation protocols.

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Section 1: Company Overview & Products

1.1 About NovaTech Solutions

NovaTech Solutions is a B2B and B2C SaaS company providing cloud-based project management, team collaboration, and AI-powered productivity tools. Founded in 2015 and headquartered in Austin, Texas, NovaTech serves over 2 million users across 80 countries. Our mission is to make teams more productive through intelligent automation and seamless collaboration.

1.2 Product Portfolio

NovaTech Core (Free / Starter)

Basic project management, up to 5 users, 5 GB storage, kanban boards, task tracking.

NovaTech Pro (Paid — Individual/Team)

Advanced project management, unlimited tasks, 50 GB storage, time tracking, integrations with Slack, Jira, GitHub.

NovaTech Business (Paid — Business)

All Pro features plus advanced reporting, 200 GB storage, priority support, SSO, audit logs, custom workflows.

NovaTech Enterprise (Custom Pricing)

All Business features plus dedicated infrastructure, 99.99% SLA, on-premise deployment, custom contracts, dedicated success manager.

NovaTech AI Assistant (Add-on)

AI-powered task suggestions, auto-scheduling, meeting summaries, and smart notifications. Available as add-on for Pro and above.

NovaDocs (Bundled / Standalone)

Collaborative document editor with version history, templates, and export to PDF/Word. Bundled with Business and Enterprise plans.

NovaAnalytics (Add-on / Enterprise)

Advanced BI dashboards, custom KPI tracking, data exports, team performance heatmaps.

1.3 Supported Platforms

- Web App: Chrome, Firefox, Safari, Edge (latest 2 versions supported)
- Desktop: Windows 10/11, macOS 12+, Ubuntu 20.04+
- Mobile: iOS 15+, Android 10+ (native apps available)
- Browser Extension: Chrome and Firefox
- API: RESTful API and Webhooks (Pro plan and above)

Section 2: Subscription Plans & Pricing

2.1 Plan Comparison Table

Feature	Core (Free)	Pro (\$12/mo)	Business (\$35/mo)	Enterprise
Users	Up to 5	Up to 25	Up to 200	Unlimited
Storage	5 GB	50 GB	200 GB	Custom
Projects	3 active	Unlimited	Unlimited	Unlimited
Integrations	2	20+	50+	Custom
API Access	No	Yes	Yes	Yes
SSO / SAML	No	No	Yes	Yes
Priority Support	No	Email only	Email + Chat	Dedicated Manager
SLA Uptime	99.5%	99.9%	99.95%	99.99%
Custom Workflows	No	Limited	Yes	Yes
Audit Logs	No	No	Yes	Yes
AI Assistant	No	Add-on (\$5/mo)	Add-on (\$5/mo)	Included

2.2 Billing Cycles

All paid plans are billed monthly or annually. Annual billing provides a 20% discount over monthly billing. Prices listed above are per-user per-month for monthly billing.

2.3 Plan Upgrades and Downgrades

- Upgrades take effect immediately; billing is prorated for the remainder of the current cycle.
- Downgrades take effect at the start of the next billing cycle.
- When downgrading, users must ensure data usage stays within new plan limits before cycle end.
- Exceeding storage limits triggers a 7-day grace period; after that, uploads are blocked until resolved.
- Enterprise pricing requires a custom quote from the sales team. Contact sales@novatech.io.

2.4 Free Trial Policy

NovaTech Pro and Business plans offer a 14-day free trial. No credit card is required for the trial. At the end of the trial, accounts automatically revert to the Core (Free) plan unless payment information is added. Data is retained for 30 days after trial expiry before deletion. Enterprise trials are available on request and last 30 days.

Section 3: Account Management

3.1 Account Creation

Users can sign up at app.novatech.io using an email address and password, or via Google / Microsoft OAuth. Business and Enterprise accounts support domain-based SSO. After registration, users receive a verification email which must be confirmed within 48 hours.

3.2 Password and Authentication

- Minimum password length: 8 characters; must include uppercase, lowercase, and a number.
- Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) is available via Authenticator App or SMS.
- 2FA is mandatory for Business and Enterprise plan admins.
- Password reset via 'Forgot Password' link; reset link valid for 1 hour.
- After 5 failed login attempts, accounts are temporarily locked for 30 minutes.
- Session timeout: 24 hours of inactivity on web; 7 days on mobile.

3.3 User Roles and Permissions

Role	Description	Can Invite Users	Can Manage Billing
Owner	Full control of account and workspace	Yes	Yes
Admin	Manage workspace settings and members	Yes	No (view only)
Member	Create and manage assigned projects	No	No
Guest	View and comment on shared items only	No	No

3.4 Account Deletion

Account owners can delete their account from Settings > Account > Delete Account. Deletion is irreversible. All data is permanently removed within 30 days per GDPR requirements. Business and Enterprise accounts require email confirmation to support@novatech.io before deletion. If a billing cycle is active, any unused days are refunded as per the refund policy.

Section 4: Billing & Payments

4.1 Payment Methods

- Credit and Debit Cards: Visa, Mastercard, American Express, Discover.
- PayPal: Available for monthly plans only.
- ACH Bank Transfer: Available for annual Business and Enterprise plans.
- Wire Transfer: Enterprise only, minimum \$5,000/year.
- Invoicing: Available for Business (annual) and Enterprise customers.

4.2 Invoice and Receipts

Invoices are automatically generated and emailed to the billing contact on each renewal date. Past invoices are available in Settings > Billing > Invoice History. Invoices include itemized charges, tax information, and a unique invoice number. Custom purchase order (PO) numbers can be added for Enterprise customers.

4.3 Failed Payments

If a payment fails, NovaTech will retry the charge on days 3, 7, and 14 after the initial failure. The account owner receives email notifications at each retry. After 14 days without successful payment, the account is downgraded to the Core (Free) plan. Data is preserved for 30 days. To reactivate, update payment information in Settings > Billing.

4.4 Taxes

NovaTech charges applicable sales tax based on the billing address. US customers in applicable states are charged state sales tax. EU customers are charged VAT. Tax-exempt organizations must submit a valid exemption certificate to billing@novatech.io.

4.5 Proration Rules

- Mid-cycle upgrades: Charged prorated amount for upgrade immediately.
- Mid-cycle user additions (Business/Enterprise): Charged per-user prorated daily rate.
- Downgrades: No charge or credit; effective next billing cycle.
- Annual to monthly switch: Allowed only at annual renewal date.

Section 5: Technical Troubleshooting

5.1 Login Issues

Issue: Cannot log in with correct credentials

Solution: Clear browser cookies and cache. Try an incognito/private window. Check if Caps Lock is on. If using SSO, verify your organization's SSO configuration. Reset password if needed. If issue persists after reset, contact support.

Issue: Account locked after failed attempts

Solution: Wait 30 minutes for automatic unlock. Alternatively, use 'Forgot Password' to reset credentials, which also unlocks the account immediately.

Issue: 2FA code not working

Solution: Ensure device time is synchronized (2FA codes are time-based). If using SMS, check for signal. Backup codes are available in Settings > Security. Contact support to disable 2FA if backup codes are lost.

Issue: SSO login failing

Solution: Verify the SSO domain in Settings > Security > SSO Configuration. Ensure the user's email domain matches the configured SSO domain. Check IdP (Identity Provider) logs for errors. Common IdPs: Okta, Azure AD, Google Workspace.

5.2 Performance Issues

Issue: App loading slowly

Solution: Check internet connection speed (minimum recommended: 5 Mbps). Disable browser extensions. Clear cache. Try a different browser. Check status.novatech.io for ongoing incidents.

Issue: File uploads failing

Solution: Verify file size is within plan limits (Core: 25 MB/file, Pro: 100 MB/file, Business/Enterprise: 500 MB/file). Check storage quota in Settings > Storage. Supported formats: PDF, DOCX, XLSX, PNG, JPG, MP4, ZIP. Corrupt files may fail silently.

Issue: Notifications not working

Solution: Check notification settings in Settings > Notifications. Ensure the NovaTech domain (novatech.io) is not blocked by email/spam filters. Browser notifications require permission to be granted in browser settings.

Issue: Real-time sync not updating

Solution: Refresh the page. Check network stability. If using mobile, ensure background app refresh is enabled. Real-time sync requires a stable WebSocket connection (port 443).

5.3 Integration Troubleshooting

Issue: Slack integration not posting

Solution: Re-authorize the Slack app in Settings > Integrations > Slack. Ensure the bot has permission to post in the target channel. Check that the workspace admin has not restricted third-party app installs.

Issue: GitHub sync not working

Solution: Verify repository permissions. The GitHub token must have repo and webhook scopes. Check if the organization has OAuth app restrictions enabled. Re-connect by revoking and re-authorizing under Settings > Integrations > GitHub.

Issue: Zapier/API returning 401 errors

Solution: API key may be expired or revoked. Generate a new key in Settings > API > Manage Keys. Verify the API base URL is <https://api.novatech.io/v2>. Rate limits: Core=0, Pro=1,000 req/hr, Business=10,000 req/hr, Enterprise=custom.

5.4 Data Issues

- Deleted items are moved to Trash and recoverable within 30 days (Core: 7 days).
- Permanent deletion occurs after trash retention period; not recoverable.
- Data exports available in Settings > Data > Export (JSON or CSV format).
- If data appears missing after a plan downgrade, it is archived, not deleted. Upgrade to re-access.
- Bulk import via CSV supported for tasks and contacts. Template available at novatech.io/templates.

Section 6: Returns, Refunds & Cancellations

6.1 Refund Policy

NovaTech operates a 30-day money-back guarantee for first-time subscribers on Pro and Business plans. The 30-day period begins on the date of initial subscription. Refund requests must be submitted via support@novatech.io or through the in-app chat. Approved refunds are processed within 5–10 business days to the original payment method.

6.2 Non-Refundable Situations

- Renewals (monthly or annual) after the 30-day window has passed.
- Add-on purchases (AI Assistant, NovaAnalytics) after 7 days of purchase.
- Accounts suspended for Terms of Service violations.
- Partial months when cancelling mid-cycle (monthly plan).
- Promotionally priced or discounted subscriptions (unless stated otherwise).

6.3 Cancellation Process

To cancel a subscription, go to Settings > Billing > Cancel Plan. Cancellation takes effect at the end of the current billing period. Data is retained for 30 days post-cancellation before permanent deletion. Users will receive a confirmation email within 10 minutes of cancellation. Annual plan cancellations within 30 days receive a prorated refund for unused months. After 30 days, annual plans are non-refundable but remain active until the annual period ends.

6.4 Disputed Charges

If a customer does not recognize a charge, they should first check the invoice history in Settings > Billing. If the charge is unclear, contact support with the invoice number, transaction date, and amount. NovaTech will investigate within 2 business days. Opening a credit card chargeback without first contacting NovaTech support may result in account suspension during investigation.

Section 7: Data Privacy & Security

7.1 Data Storage and Location

Customer data is stored on AWS infrastructure. Default region is US-East-1. Business and Enterprise customers can select their preferred data region: US (us-east-1), EU (eu-west-1), APAC (ap-southeast-1). Data residency selection is available during onboarding or via request to your account manager.

7.2 Compliance Certifications

- SOC 2 Type II: Audited annually. Certificate available on request.
- ISO 27001: Certified. Last audit: January 2025.
- GDPR: Fully compliant. DPA (Data Processing Agreement) available for Business and Enterprise.
- HIPAA: Business Associate Agreement (BAA) available for Enterprise customers.
- CCPA: Compliant. Privacy policy updated February 2025.

7.3 Data Encryption

All data is encrypted in transit using TLS 1.2 or higher. Data at rest is encrypted using AES-256. Encryption keys are managed via AWS KMS. Enterprise customers may request customer-managed encryption keys (CMEK).

7.4 GDPR Data Subject Requests

- Right to Access: Submit via Settings > Privacy > Download My Data or email privacy@novatech.io.
- Right to Erasure: Email privacy@novatech.io with subject 'Erasure Request'. Response within 30 days.
- Right to Portability: Data exported in JSON or CSV format within 30 days.
- Right to Rectification: Update personal data in Settings > Profile or contact support.
- Data Retention: Personal data retained for duration of account plus 30 days post-deletion.

7.5 Security Incidents

In the event of a security breach affecting customer data, NovaTech will notify affected customers within 72 hours as required by GDPR. Notifications are sent to the account owner's email address. Security advisories are published at security.novatech.io. To report a vulnerability, email security@novatech.io.

Section 8: Service Level Agreements (SLA)

8.1 Uptime Commitments

Plan	Monthly Uptime Guarantee	Scheduled Maintenance Window	Compensation for Breach
Core (Free)	99.5%	Saturday 2–4 AM UTC	None
Pro	99.9%	Saturday 2–4 AM UTC	10% credit per 1hr downtime
Business	99.95%	Saturday 1–3 AM UTC	15% credit per 1hr downtime
Enterprise	99.99%	By agreement	20% credit per 30min downtime

8.2 Support Response Times

Plan	Channel	First Response SLA	Resolution SLA
Core	Community forum only	N/A (community-driven)	N/A
Pro	Email	24 business hours	72 business hours
Business	Email + Live Chat	4 business hours	24 business hours
Enterprise	Email + Chat + Phone	1 hour (24/7)	4 hours (P1 issues)

8.3 Incident Severity Definitions

Priority	Definition	Example
P1 — Critical	Complete service outage or data loss	All users cannot login; database corrupted
P2 — High	Major feature unavailable; workaround exists	File uploads failing for all users
P3 — Medium	Minor feature issue affecting some users	Notifications delayed by 30+ minutes
P4 — Low	Cosmetic issue or enhancement request	UI text misaligned on a specific browser

Section 9: Escalation & Human Handoff Protocol

9.1 When to Escalate to a Human Agent

The AI support assistant should escalate to a human agent in any of the following situations. Escalation ensures customer trust, compliance, and satisfaction on complex or sensitive issues.

- Billing disputes involving charges over \$200 or suspected fraudulent transactions.
- Account recovery requests where identity verification is required.
- Legal or compliance inquiries, including GDPR data deletion requests.
- Customers expressing frustration, anger, or explicitly requesting a human agent.
- Security incident reports or suspected data breaches.
- Enterprise contract negotiations, renewals, or custom pricing requests.
- Queries involving potential Terms of Service violations or account suspension appeals.
- Technical issues not resolved after two troubleshooting attempts.
- Any situation where the AI has low confidence in its response (below 0.65 threshold).
- Requests involving sensitive personal or health information.

9.2 Escalation Routing

Issue Type	Route To	Contact
Billing disputes	Billing Specialist	billing@novatech.io
Technical (P1/P2)	Senior Engineer On-Call	oncall@novatech.io
Legal / GDPR	Compliance Officer	privacy@novatech.io
Enterprise Accounts	Account Manager	Dedicated manager assigned
Security Incidents	Security Team	security@novatech.io
General Escalation	Tier 2 Support Queue	support@novatech.io

9.3 Escalation Message Template

When escalating, the AI assistant should communicate the following to the customer:

"I want to make sure you get the best help possible for this situation. I'm connecting you with a specialist from our support team who will be able to assist you further. Please expect a response within [SLA time based on plan]. Your case reference is [CASE_ID]. Thank you for your patience."

Section 10: Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

Q1. How do I upgrade my plan?

Go to Settings > Billing > Change Plan. Select your desired plan and confirm. Upgrades take effect immediately with prorated billing. You can also contact support for assistance.

Q2. Can I use NovaTech offline?

NovaTech requires an internet connection for real-time features. The desktop app caches recent data for offline viewing, but editing is disabled offline. Changes made offline sync automatically when reconnected.

Q3. How do I add team members?

Go to Settings > Team > Invite Members. Enter email addresses and assign roles. Invitees receive an email with a join link valid for 7 days. On the Core plan, maximum team size is 5 members.

Q4. What happens to my data if I cancel?

Data is retained for 30 days after cancellation. You can export your data in Settings > Data > Export before the retention period ends. After 30 days, all data is permanently deleted.

Q5. Can I have multiple workspaces?

Yes. Pro users can create up to 3 workspaces. Business users can create unlimited workspaces. Each workspace is billed separately unless consolidated under an Enterprise account.

Q6. How do I export project data?

Go to Settings > Data > Export. Choose format (JSON or CSV) and select the projects to export. Export files are generated within 10 minutes and emailed to the account owner.

Q7. Does NovaTech integrate with Google Workspace?

Yes. NovaTech integrates with Google Calendar, Google Drive, and Gmail. Set up under Settings > Integrations > Google Workspace. Requires Google account authorization. Available for Pro and above.

Q8. What is the maximum file size I can upload?

Core: 25 MB per file. Pro: 100 MB per file. Business: 500 MB per file. Enterprise: Custom (up to 5 GB with configuration). Total storage per plan: Core 5 GB, Pro 50 GB, Business 200 GB, Enterprise custom.

Q9. How does the AI Assistant work?

The AI Assistant uses your project data to suggest task priorities, detect blockers, summarize meeting notes, and auto-schedule tasks. It does not share your data with third parties. AI features can be disabled in Settings > AI > Disable AI Features.

Q10. How do I reset my 2FA?

If you have backup codes, use one at login and reconfigure 2FA in Settings > Security. If backup codes are unavailable, contact support@novatech.io with account verification details. Identity verification will be required before 2FA is reset.

Q11. Can I switch from monthly to annual billing?

Yes. Go to Settings > Billing > Switch to Annual. You will be charged the annual rate immediately, minus credit for the unused portion of your current monthly cycle. The annual period begins immediately.

Q12. Is there a student or nonprofit discount?

Yes. Verified students and nonprofit organizations receive a 50% discount on Pro plans. Submit verification documents to discounts@novatech.io. Approved discounts apply within 3 business days.

Q13. How do I contact support?

Core plan users: community.novatech.io. Pro users: support@novatech.io. Business users: Email + live chat at app.novatech.io. Enterprise: Dedicated phone line provided at onboarding.

Q14. What browsers are supported?

Chrome (v90+), Firefox (v88+), Safari (v14+), Edge (v90+). Internet Explorer is not supported. For the best experience, use the latest version of Chrome or Firefox.

Q15. How long does it take to process a refund?

Approved refunds are processed within 5–10 business days to the original payment method. For PayPal, processing may take up to 5 additional days. A confirmation email is sent once the refund is initiated.

Appendix A: Quick Reference — Key Contacts

Department	Email	Notes
General Support	support@novatech.io	Pro: 24hr, Business: 4hr, Enterprise: 1hr
Billing	billing@novatech.io	Invoice disputes, failed payments
Privacy / GDPR	privacy@novatech.io	Data requests, DPA
Security	security@novatech.io	Vulnerabilities, incidents
Sales / Enterprise	sales@novatech.io	Custom pricing, contracts
Discounts	discounts@novatech.io	Student, nonprofit
Status Page	status.novatech.io	Incidents, maintenance
Community Forum	community.novatech.io	Core plan users, peer support

Appendix B: Glossary

SLA: Service Level Agreement — contractual uptime and response guarantees.

SSO: Single Sign-On — allows login via a corporate identity provider.

2FA: Two-Factor Authentication — second verification step at login.

GDPR: General Data Protection Regulation — EU data privacy law.

HIPAA: Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act — US healthcare data law.

CMEK: Customer-Managed Encryption Keys — customer controls encryption keys.

P1/P2/P3/P4: Incident priority levels from critical to low.

BAA: Business Associate Agreement — HIPAA-required agreement.

DPA: Data Processing Agreement — GDPR-required agreement with processors.

ACH: Automated Clearing House — US electronic bank transfer network.

KMS: Key Management Service — AWS service for managing encryption keys.

HITL: Human-in-the-Loop — escalation from automated to human agent.

Proration: Adjusting a charge proportionally for partial billing periods.

Workspace: A dedicated organizational environment within NovaTech.